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IS SPORTS SCIENCE WORTH THE HYPE?

Sports science **represents the future,** and it is here to stay. But is it worth the investment?

Everything is theoretically impossible, until it is done" — Robert A. Heinlein

In the current global sporting scenario, especially in the Indian context, the buzzwords are High Performance Centre, Centre of Excellence, Peak Performance Centre, or even Sports Science Centre, among many others.

There is little doubt that there exists hardly any high-performance team, elite athlete, or everyday sporting individual who does not employ sports science or its professionals in some form to enhance their performance.

There has been a huge transition in sports science since its inception. Version 1 started strong and taught us how to look at performance from a physiological perspective — how strength and conditioning work, how human adaptation functions, and how periodised regimes shape world-beaters. It was never perfect, but it was a bold beginning — a new and real start.

The next avatar

Version 2 followed, bringing in sports technology and cutting-edge tools, with an overwhelming stream of data flooding the domain. But somewhere along the way, we started getting lost. We are beginning to forget what matters most, becoming fixated on number-crunching. This version promises more, yet we are still learning how to harness it. So much is being measured, but so little is truly understood.

In today's scenario, where data analysis is essential to stay competitive, the soul of the sport is slowly being eroded. Human intervention remains the ultimate tool — planning with technology, tracking performance, and working together. Human wisdom and technology must work in tandem to create world-beaters. It's a concoction of science and belief — both necessary for true excellence.

Sports science and its domain represent the future, and

it is here to stay. In India, the majority of us may still be unaware of what it truly is all about and its implications in the performance domain — how the entire system can be a game changer on the world sporting stage.

The truth is, it's all around us — we just aren't fully aware of it yet. You may just be a regular individual who engages in physical activity to stay fit, or you may be part of a sports team that follows a strict regime. Either way, sports science is fundamental to any training programme.

It's all in the data

While high-performance teams — or even state teams — implement advanced GPS equipment to monitor metrics such as distances covered, heart rates, and many other variables specific to each sport, skill, and even individual, you can now find similar equipment at your local sports store. This is a sign that sports science is becoming part of our daily lives.

The foundation of sports science lies in collecting data and monitoring performance — knowing where you started and what you've done to ensure your next performance improves progressively, backed by accurate data. There are world-class performance monitoring systems developed to take this data in and 'spit out' useful information tailored to